

BARZOR-FREMI NON-WOOD FOREST PRODUCT MANAGEMENT PLAN



**GOMDAR GEWOG
(1st Revision)
Plan Period-2023 to 2028**



APPROVAL SHEET

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Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group:	Barzor NWFP Management and Marketing Group
Dzongkhag:	Samdrup Jongkhar
Gewog:	Gomdar
Village(s):	Barzor and Fremi
No. of households:	57
Area (ha)	400ha
Plan Period:	2023-2028

Prepared and submitted for approval

	NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Gewog Administration	Social Forestry Section Head	Head of the Division/Park
Signature:				
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Title:	Chairman	GUP GEWOG ADMINISTRATION GOMDAR	Be. R	CFO

REVIEWED AND RECOMMENDED FOR APPROVAL

	Reviewing Officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Signature		
Name	Kezang Wangmo	
Position Title	By CFO	

APPROVED BY



DIRECTOR
Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

Table of Contents

APPROVAL SHEET	3
Section A: NWFP management and marketing plan	5
1. Background.....	5
2. The traditional rights over natural resources.....	5
3. Review and achievement of previous management plan period.....	5
4. Objectives	5
5. Description of NWFPs.....	6
6. Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting	6
7. Marketing and sales plan.....	8
8. Marketing arrangements	9
8.1 Benefits to the members.....	9
8.2 Benefit to the group.....	9
NWFPs HARVESTING CALENDER	10
Section B: BY-LAWS.....	10
9. Members of the NWFP management and marketing groups and their responsibilities.....	10
10. Roles and responsibilities of Executive Members	11
11. Fund utilization	13
12. Conflict Management and resolution.....	13
13. Fines and Penalties.....	14
Annexure I: Members list	14
List of Figure	
Figure 1. NWFP Boundary Map.....	8
List of Tables	
Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial purposes.....	6
Table 2. Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting of NWFP species	7
Table 3. Marketing and sales plan for harvested NWFPs.....	8
Table 4. NWFP harvesting calendar and collection area	10

Section A: NWFP management and marketing plan

1. Background

The Bazor-Fremi Non-Wood Forest management group was formed in 2017 with a member of 46 household. With the revision of plan in 2023 the group will be managed by 57 household of Barzor and Fremi village.

The Barzor Non-wood Forest product management plan completes its 5-year plan period in 2023. The management plan has been revised to guide, maintain, protect, and enhance the NWFPs in the Barzor and Fremi forest areas. The forest area surrounding the village is covered with rich forest resources of both timber and non-timber products. The Non-wood forest management plan extends a variety of long-term goals, strategies, and priorities to protect the forest resources to improve well-being of the community and future generations. The people of the village produce agricultural products or derive their income from agricultural and livestock farming. The communities depend on livestock products through cattle rearing. The forest is extensively used for timber, firewood and fodder collection. NWFPs are used for domestic purposes and the excess products are marketed.

The Barzor-Fremi village is connected with farm road which is around 12 km from the Gewog center. The community is well connected with electricity, network connectivity and rural water supply scheme. The other facilities include presence of a primary school.

The Barzor-Fremi village lies in cool broad-leaved forest and is a good habitat for the NWFPs like *Plectocomia himalayana*, *Rubia cordifolia*, *Pouzolzia spp.* *Viscum album*, *Tupistra nutans* etc.

2. The traditional rights over natural resources

The community of Barzor and Fremi has no right over the natural resources in the past. However, after the successful formation of the non-wood forest product management group in 2017, the community has managed and controlled the area from outsider for collection of forest produces. With the revised management plan in place, the community can use NWFP resources sustainably and improved well-being of the community through sale of products on a sustainable basis.

3. Review and achievement of previous management plan period

During the last plan period, the group was not able to implement the plan as per their expectation due to pandemic. The group conducted few meetings and marketed some NWFP products from which they generated Nu.10000 only. The main challenge faced by the group was the marketing of NWFP products.

4. Objectives

- ✓ Sustainable harvesting of NWFPs and protection from outsiders
- ✓ To generate income through sale of NWFPs products
- ✓ Protection of *Plectocomia himalayana* (Patsha) and *Neomicrocalamus andropogonifolius* (Ringshu)

5. Description of NWFPs

There are around eight species of NWFP found in the forest near their settlement. The different species of NWFPs include Mushrooms, Ferns, *Elatostema* sp, *Rubia cordifolia*, *Pouzolzia* spp, *Daphne* and *Chirata*. During this plan period, the groups prioritized the conservation of NWFP species that are of at high risk of extinction if no proper management intervention is made. The species includes *Plectocomia himalayana*, *Neomicrocalamus andropogonifolius* and *Paris polyphylla*. These three species are restricted for collection during this management plan period. The detail management and harvesting of different NWFP products are given in the table below:

Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial purposes

NWFP name	Harvesting area	Parts used	Use purpose (traditional & other	Harvesting season (month)	Estimated quantity that can be collected
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i> (Damuru)	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Stem and leaves	Vegetable	April -Sept	1000 kg
Fern	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Shoot	Vegetable	April-Sept	1500 kg
<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> (Laniru)	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Entire part	dyes (color)	Nov-Feb	5000 kg
<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp (Yongdiba)	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Bark	Adhesive, Incense	Aug-Feb	2000 kg
Mushroom	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Entire part	Vegetable	April-Sept	100 kg
<i>Daphne</i> spp	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Bark	Traditional paper	March-June	1000 kg
<i>Viscum album</i>	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Twigs	Ingredient / tea	Sept-Feb	100 kg
Thormom (<i>Tupistra nutans</i>)	Barzor and Fremi-phu	Flowers	vegetable	Oct-Nov	100 kg

6. Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting

The user group members will strictly follow the guidelines and prescriptions formulated in the table below to ensure sustainable utilization of resources and to promote natural regeneration for

present and future. The NWFPs and other species which are not reflected in the management plan will also be carried out in line with procedural requirement mentioned in FNCRR 2017 and its amendments.

Table 2. Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting of NWFP species

NWFP species	Harvesting prescription for sustainable harvesting
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	• Collect plants that are 15cm and above or matured ones. • Retain stump of around 3'' for sprouting of new shoots. • Do not uproot whole plant. • Should not cut down trees and create more opening. • Should not disturb its catchment area.
Fern	• Harvest only young shoot that are 15 cm long • Do not harvest the entire shoot coming up in season • Do not harvest the shoots that have developed to leaves. • Do not cut down trees which provide shade to plant • Retain at least 50% of young shoot of last flush for development of leaves
Laniru (<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>)	• Use sharp scissors for the collection of the upper part of the plant. • Cut the plant at 5 cm above ground level. • Leave at least 10% of the plants without collecting for next time regeneration purposes • Do not collect roots • Do not uproot entire plants
Yongdiba (<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp)	• Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level • Do not damage the remaining young stands/seedlings/saplings • Felling of surrounding trees to ease harvesting is prohibited • Leave at least 10% of the plants to allow natural regeneration • Harvesting of roots is strictly prohibited for ecological reason
Mushroom	• Do not uproot entire plant • Collect only mature one leaving young one • Harvest carefully
<i>Daphne</i> spp.	• Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level • Cut only the stems that are 10 cm in diameter • Do not damage the remaining young stands/seedlings/saplings • Do not fell the surrounding trees in order to clear the area to ease harvesting • Harvesting should be done on rotational basis, once in 5 years for every block.



Figure 1. NWFP Boundary Map

7. Marketing and sales plan

The NWFPs will be marketed to local market at Gomdar, Narphu and to Samdrup Jongkhar for products like *Ferns*, *Viscum album*, *Mushroom* and *Tupistra*. But for products like *Pouzolzia spp.*, *Daphne* and *Rubia cordifolia* will be sold to trader for export after completing all the formalities.

Table 3. Marketing and sales plan for harvested NWFPs

NWFPs	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)	Expected selling price per unit (Nu)	Total (Nu)
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	Local market/Samdrup Jongkhar town	500 bundles	Nu. 20	10000
Fern shoots	Samdrup Jongkhar town / Local market	300 bundles	Nu. 10/kg	3000
Yongjibu (<i>Pouzolzia spp.</i>)	NWFPs license holder	200 kg	Nu.50/kg	10000
<i>Viscum album</i>	Local / SJ Throm/Narphung	20 kg	Nu.50/kg	1000
<i>Daphne spp</i>	Local/export	200 kg	Nu. 20/kg	4000

<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>	Samdrup Jongkhar Throm / NWFP license holder	1000 kg	Nu.50/kg	50000
<i>Mushroom</i>	Local market	20 kg	150/kg	3000
<i>Tupistra nutans</i>	Local market	20 kg	50 kg	1000

8. Marketing arrangements

- NWFPs will be harvested as per the management prescription for sale with prior permission from the chairperson and the committee members.
- The quantity of the products for sale by individual will be first assessed by the chairperson and secretary to ensure proper recording and payment towards community fund after coming back from the market.
- The group members shall market their products individually or in group as per their convenient.
- Any member who sales the NWFPs products without permission of chairperson and committee members will be fined with Nu. 1000 and seize the products or the total income earned from the sale.
- If there is a large quantity of NWFPs to be marketed, the NWFP group chairperson and committee members will seek enough support from the relevant stakeholders through Gewog Administration.
- General consultation will be conducted by chairperson and secretary to address issues related to marketing and other important plans and activities for future.

8.1 Benefits to the members

- All members can generate income through sale of NWFPs as well as even handicraft items if there is potential.
- Each member has right to get equal share from the accumulated group fund
- The group members shall look after the welfare of sick old and needy people of the group and render every possible help

8.2 Benefit to the group.

- Follow Sustainable harvesting guidelines and management plan.
- Easy access to permit for NWFPs harvesting and marketing
- Reduce illegal and unsustainable harvesting of NWFPs.
- Community will benefit from group fund.
- Fund will be deposited in one financial institution in a group account.

NWFPs HARVESTING CALENDER

Table 4. NWFP harvesting calendar and collection area

Harvesting year	Name of Collecting area	Remarks
1 st Year	Fremi Phu	Harvesting of products like ferns and <i>Elatostema</i> species can be collected throughout the season as per harvesting prescription in management plan
2 nd Year	Barzor	
3 rd Year	Fremi phu	
4 th Year	Barzor	
5 th Year	Fremi phu	

Section B: BY-LAWS

9. Members of the NWFP management and marketing groups and their responsibilities

Village	Number of member households	Gewog
Barzor and Fremi	58	Gomdar
Membership arrangement and rights of members: ➤ Only the residents of Barzor and Fremi village with proper gung and census are eligible to become a member of NWFPs mgt. group. ➤ If he/she is fragmented from the main gung and wanted to become a new member can join as member after paying entry fee of Nu.100 (one hundred) only. ➤ The person wishing to join the group must apply to chairperson. His/her membership would be decided by the group members during the general meeting and then make aware of group's objectives, plan and by-laws. ➤ If a new member who settles at Bazor-Fremi wants to join as member, he/she can become a member after paying sum of entry fee and total accumulated budget divided by total members ➤ Any member wish to resign from membership due to genuine problem or reason (resettlement program) shall be entitled 50 percent of individual share from the common fund. ➤ Any member who deliberately withdraws from the group member shall not be given any benefits and forest resources from the NWFPs delineated areas base on the traditional boundaries. ➤ The members have right to terminate/re-elect the executive members if misuse their responsibilities. ➤ All members will contribute an annual membership fee of Nu.100 Responsibilities of members: ➤ Active participation in meetings, trainings and also in general assembly twice a year.		

- All members should participate in protection, sustainable management and harvesting of NWFPs.
- The entire group member will actively participate in patrolling their NWFPs growing areas twice a year on rotational basis.
- Inform/avail permit from chairperson for collection of NWFPs and provide correct information for proper recording after marketing.
- Harvest, manage and utilized the NWFPs on sustainable basis as per the management guidelines and prescriptions.
- Report of any illegal activities to chairperson and committee's members for case settlement

10. Roles and responsibilities of Executive Members

Executive committee The 3 elected executive committee members will act as representatives of the NWFP Group pertaining to the management and utilization of the resources. The terms for these executive committee members were fixed for the period of five years without the incentives. However, they can resign or terminated before the completion of their terms if their performances are not satisfactory. The termination or resignation of executive committee will take place during the general assembly and the NWFP group members will approve the termination/resignation from the executive membership and nominate/elect the new member through voting system.	
	Name of Chairperson: Dorji Wangchuk
Chairperson	➤ Chair the meeting related to NWFPs management, utilization and marketing. ➤ Work in close coordination with other organizations, sectors and agencies, and seek assistance for the development of management group. ➤ To arrange and coordinate the marketing of NWFPs and handicraft items. ➤ Represent the group in meetings that will take place in other parts of the country and share information and ideas acquired from the meeting with the group members. ➤ Resolve disputes and conflicts arising among the group members and maintain good working relations. ➤ Coordinate the patrolling of NWFPs prevailing areas from time to time on rotational basis. ➤ Initiate annual planning and progress report submission to Gewog Forest Ranger and Chief Forest Officer through RO. ➤ Jointly sign with the Secretary and Treasurer on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.

	Name of Secretary: Tendi
Secretary	➤ Officiate the chairperson in his absence. ➤ Inform the date, time and venue of meeting to all the group members. ➤ Keep minutes of NWFPs related meetings and make presentation at the end. ➤ Assist the chairperson in solving conflicts arising among members and maintain good working relations, and also in marketing of NWFPs. ➤ Keep proper record and data of NWFPs collected and marketed. ➤ Jointly sign with the Chairperson and Treasurer on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.
	Name of Treasurer: Sonam Dorji
Treasurer	➤ Keep proper records and accountings of NWFPs and assist the chairperson and secretary in marketing. ➤ Issue a receipt to the individual for quantity of NWFPs collected for sale. ➤ Keep annual financial transaction records and present to the group members during the general assembly. ➤ Collect and deposit the money in the NWFPs group account maintained with the nearest financial institution. ➤ Jointly sign with the Chairperson and Secretary on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.

Compensation to the executive committee for marketing	The community has unanimously decided to do away with the payment of the compensation practice to the executive committee members for marketing services. The committee along with few group members will work on rotational basis for the benefit of all the community members without any incentives.
Membership fee and purpose	Every member shall contribute annual membership fee of Nu. 50 (fifty) only. The amount will be deposited in the nearest bank and utilized the accumulated amount for the welfare of the NWFPs group members in the near future. The amount can even use for pre-financing the marketing cost of NWFPs

11. Fund utilization

Community development fund and utilization of fund	The community development fund will be generated through following means; ➤ Membership fees collection ➤ Sale of NWFPs like ferns, mushrooms, Damroo, <i>Rubia</i>, <i>Pouzolzia</i> species etc. 5% deduction of the total sale value of the NWFPs from every individual ➤ Fines and penalties of absentees and illegal doers ➤ Contribution and donation from visitors and other relevant agencies. The accumulated common fund will be managed & utilized for the welfare of group members as follows; ➤ The common fund generating from above means will maintain in the group saving account with the BDBL. ➤ Whether to give loan to the needy member or not will be decided during the annual general assembly and accordingly frame separate internal rules and regulations. ➤ The fund will be utilized for the procurement of office stationeries, seals, printing of permits books, money receipt etc. ➤ In order to meet the small internal expenses, either the chairperson or the secretary has authority to keep the community fund of Nu. 3000 (three thousand) only in their hands. For any further changes, the issue will discuss during the annual general assembly in future.
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12. Conflict Management and resolution

Conflict resolution	➤ The chairperson and the secretary shall solve the conflict arising among the group members. ➤ If the conflict arises between executive committee members and the group members, the matter shall be forwarded to Chiwog Tshogpa followed by Gewog Forestry staff and Gewog Administration by chairperson for final decision. ➤ If the problem arises between group members and the outsiders, the matter shall directly forward to the Gewog Administration for settlement followed by Dzongkhag Administration if it is not solved at gewog level. Collection or harvesting of NWFPs for home consumption purposes will be free of royalty while for commercial purposes will face certain percentage deductions towards community development fund from the total sales of every individual. However, the fines and penalties against the illegal doers will be imposed both for group members as well as non-members in the following ways;
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13. Fines and Penalties

Penalties	Name of NWFPs	Fines and penalties for illegal collection
	<i>Daphne</i> sp	Nu. 20 per kg& seize
	Mushroom spp.	Nu. 20 per kg seize
	Fern shoots	Nu. 10 per bundle & seize
	Rubia spp. (Lanero)+ Yongjibu	Nu. 50 per kg & seize
	<i>Viscum album</i>	Nu. 40 per kg& seize (Raw) Nu. 100 per kg & seize (value added)
	<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	Nu.15 per kg & seize
	Harvesting from un-identified locations	Nu. 100 & seize
	If illegal collection of any NWFPs not listed in the mgt. plan	As per the FNCRR with kind support from the forestry officials
	Other norms and penalties of the group members	
	Misuse of fund by the executive committee members	Should repay the amount with existing bank interest rate
	If any committee members fail to deliver service	Terminate him/her and appoint new ones through voting system
	Failure to attend meeting	Nu.215
	Failure to attend work	Nu. 250

Annexure I: Members list

Sl.No	Name	CID No	Village
1	Dorji wangchuk	11102002878	Bazor
2	Tendel Wangdi	11102002843	Fremi
3	Tshering Wangchuk	11102000476	Bazor
4	Kezang Choden	11102000600	Bazor
5	Tendel Zangpo	11102000601	Bazor
6	Tashi Zangoo	11102000575	Bazor
7	Youten Jamtsho	11102002969	Fremi
8	Jigme Wangmo	11102000455	Bazor
9	Jambay Dema	11102002014	Bazor
10	Tshering Dema	11102003089	Fremi
11	Tandin Zangmo	11102000535	Bazor
12	Melam Choden	11102000538	Bazor
13	Sangay Choden	11102003943	Bazor
14	Pema Deki	11102001550	Bazor
15	Lekden Pema	11102002941	Bazor
16	Changlo	11102002936	Fremi
17	Nima Thsering	11102000443	Bazor
18	Namgyal	11102002828	Fremi
19	Thinley Jamtsho	11102002975	Fremi

20	Sangay Wangchuk	11102000586	Bazor
21	Peldon	11102002975	Fremi
22	Sonam Jamtsho	11102002987	Fremi
23	Sangay Wangchuk	11102003031	Fremi
24	Dorji Wangdi	11102003068	Fremi
25	Bumpa	11102002952	Fremi
26	Tsagay	11102000506	Bazor
27	Youten Jamtsho	11102000433	Bazor
28	Tendel Zangmo	11102002942	Bazor
29	Dawa Zangmo	10906001111	Bazor
30	Yangki Lhamo	11102002998	Fremi
31	Dorji	11102000461	Bazor
32	Tendi	11102002814	Bazor
33	Thinley	11102003092	Fremi
34	Karma Yezer	11102002867	Fremi
35	Khotsa	11102002978	Fremi
36	Sonam Chozom	11102000592	Bazor
37	Sonam Rinchen	11102000498	Bazor
38	Lungten Zangmo	11102007682	Fremi
39	Karma Tshewang	11102000425	fremi
40	Sacha	11102000597	Fremi
41	Karma	11102000515	Bazor
42	Tshering Zangmo	11102003095	fremi
43	Zangpo	11102000536	Bazor
44	Sangay Penjor	11102002791	Fremi
45	Kinzang Norbu	11102002912	Fremi
46	Namgay Wangchuk	11102003012	Fremi
47	Karma Wangdi	11102002853	Fremi
48	Tashi Penjor	11102002819	Fremi
49	Choeda	11102000447	Fremi
50	Sagteng	11102000425	Bazor
51	Sonam Zangpo	11102000539	Bazor
52	Chimi Rinnzin	11102003069	Bazor
53	Choden		Bazor
54	Cheki Wangmo		Fremi
55	Sonam Tshering	11102000560	Bazor
56	Mindu Gyelthsen		Fremi
57	Sangay Dolma		Fremi

